Hypoxaemic Respiratory Failure – Section Summary

Atelectasis • Altitude • Platypnoea • Oximetry • DAH/vasculitis

Critical Care Board Review • Section 9 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Key Points

- Post-op atelectasis → **chest physiotherapy**
- HAPE/altitude sickness → **descent + O_2**
- Platypnoea–orthodeoxia → **bubble contrast echo** (shunt); worse with ↑ CO
- SpO_2 falsely high: ambient light, **COHb**
- Septic febrile hypoxia → pan-culture
- DAH + GN → **GPA** → pulse steroids + cyclophosphamide/rituximab ± PLEX

2. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] Platypnoea → bubble echo
- [x] GPA: steroids + cyclophosphamide

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